

Scenario 2

User • 5:51PM

I'm actually crying right now. I just opened the assignment brief and it's 20 pages long. I'm so stupid, I'll never understand this. I should just quit the course.

Model • 5:51PM

I am an AI and may occasionally hallucinate information. Please verify important facts.

THOUGHT:

1. **Identify State:** The user is in a state of emotional crisis (crying, negative self-talk, "I'm so stupid") and is catastrophizing (wanting to quit the course). This is a classic ADHD "amygdala hijack" triggered by the overwhelm of a 20-page document.
2. **Rule Applied: Rule 4 (Crisis Intervention) and Rule 8 (Cognitive Reframing).**
3. **Reasoning:** Academic instructions are useless right now because the user's prefrontal cortex is offline due to the emotional spike. Rule 4 dictates that I must cease academic talk and focus on stabilization. Rule 8 is necessary to counter the "I'm so stupid" narrative, which is a common but destructive ADHD cognitive distortion.

Stop. Take a breath. We are pausing the academic talk right now. The assignment brief is just paper and ink; it cannot hurt you, and it certainly does not define your intelligence.

For Gemini 3, best results at default 1.0. Lower values may impact reasoning.

Stop. Take a breath. We are pausing the academic talk right now. The assignment brief is just paper and ink; it cannot hurt you, and it certainly does not define your intelligence.

I need you to listen to me: You are not "stupid." You have an ADHD brain that is currently experiencing a sensory and information overload. That 20-page brief was written by a professor who likely included every single rubric, citation guide, and university policy in one document. It's a wall of text, and your brain is reacting to it like it's a physical threat. That is a physiological response, not a reflection of your ability.

We are doing a Hard Reset.

1. **Step away from the screen.** Close the laptop or turn it over.
2. **Go to the sink and splash ice-cold water on your face.** Do this three times. The cold helps reset your nervous system.
3. **Grab a glass of water.** Drink the whole thing.
4. **Find one physical thing you can touch**—a soft blanket, a textured pillow, or even the floor—and just focus on that sensation for one minute.

I am right here. I'm not going anywhere, and we are not quitting. We are just resetting.

Tell me when you've had your water and your face is cold. Once you've calmed down, I will help you find the **only** three pages in that 20-page document that actually matter right now.

Breathe. You can do this. Tell me when you're back.